3. Sentence with focused object = object becomes the first in the sentence, the rest of the order is preserved.
   Nga man gisoon. ('I saw *you*$_{SG}$.')

7.4 Morphosyntactic alignment

This refers to the way in which three verbal arguments (subject of intransitive verb, subject of transitive verb, object) behave. For simplicity, in this chapter we will use the following notation: Subject of intransitive verb = Subject = S, Subject of transitive verb = Agent = A, Direct object = Object = O.

In order to better illustrate this concept, let us consider the following problem:

Problem 7.2

Morphosyntactic alignments (Vlad A. Neacșu, RoLO 2016)

The following 16 sentences represent the translations of four different English sentences into four different languages, *in random order*:

1. *Bayi jugumbil baŋgul gúdaŋgu buṛan.*
2. *'ua hi'o te tamari'i.*
3. *Bayi yaṛa buṛan.*
4. *Pol'eʔi hina nawta.*
5. *Cíq'ămqalnim peexne 'áyatne.*
6. *'ua hi'o te 'ūrī 'i te vahine.*
7. *Háma peexne.*
8. *Bayi gagara baŋgul yaṛaŋgu buṛan.*
9. *Met'aii pol'eʔ nawta.*
10. *'áyatnim peexne hámane.*
11. *'ua hi'o te tamari'i 'i te 'āva'e.*
12. *Pol'eʔi nawta.*
13. *'ua hi'o te vahine 'i te tamari'i.*
14. *Hámanim peexne hísemtuksne.*
15. *Bayi yaṛa baŋgul jugumbilŋgu buṛan.*
16. *Tsu'itsui met'ai nawta.*

Problem 7.2a Group the 16 sentences into four groups, based on the language they are in.

Problem 7.2b Group the 16 sentences into four groups, based on their meaning.

Problem 7.2c Here are eight more sentences:

17. *'ua hi'o 'i te vahine.*
18. *Met'ai pol'eʔi nawta.*

19. *Bayi gúda buṛan.*
20. *Cíq'ămqalnim peexne.*
21. *'ua te hi'o 'i te tamari vahine.*
22. *Bayi jugumbilŋgu baŋgul yaṛa buṛan.*
23. *Pol'e?i pol'e? nawta.*
24. *Peexne 'áyatnim háma.*

Out of these sentences, six are wrong. Which are these and why are they wrong?

Problem 7.2d Translate the two correct sentences from task (c) into the other three languages.

Solution

Step 1. The sentence grouping based on language can be easily done considering that all sentences in Language 1 (Dyirbal) contain the word *buṛan*, all sentences in Language 2 (Tahitian) start with *'ua hi'o*, all sentences in Language 3 (Nez-Perce) contain the word *peexne*, and all sentences in Language 4 (Wappo) end in *nawta*.

Step 2. Based on the previous grouping, we have the categories:

Lang. 1 (Dyirbal)

1. *Bayi jugumbil baŋgul gúdaŋgu buṛan.*
3. *Bayi yaṛa buṛan.*
8. *Bayi gagara baŋgul yaṛaŋgu buṛan.*
15. *Bayi yaṛa baŋgul jugumbilŋgu buṛan.*

Lang. 2 (Tahitian)

2. *'ua hi'o te tamari'i.*
6. *'ua hi'o te 'ūrī 'i te vahine.*
11. *'ua hi'o te tamari'i 'i te 'āva'e.*
13. *'ua hi'o te vahine 'i te tamari'i.*

Lang. 3 (Nez-Perce)

5. *Cíq'ămqalnim peexne 'áyatne.*